

FITNESS TRACKERS AND SMART WATCHES

EYEING A FITNESS TRACKER OR SMARTWATCH? READ THIS FIRST.

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THE BEST DEVICES AVAILABLE

When it comes to smartwatches, one of the best devices available in the market right now is the Fitbit Versa Lite Edition, for less than ₹13K. It does all the essential tasks admirably well, and even has continuous heart rate monitoring. There are alerts for calls



The Fitbit Versa is just about the best smartwatch available

and messages, and you can also load songs into it and use the device as an mp3 player. The screen is nice and bright, and is protected with Gorilla Glass 3 as

well. The device is comfortable to wear, lightweight and the battery lasts an admirable four days. The soft silicon strap does not get scratchy even if you begin to perspire. It does not have GPS tracking, but can pair with, and use the geolocation details, from your phone. There is also no Wi-Fi support. Compared to the Fitbit Versa, you cannot measure climbing distance or laps during a swimming session though. The Fitbit Charge 3 is also a great offering, but it makes sense now to expand your budget a little more and get the Versa Lite. In case you own an Apple phone though, it is best to go for the latest Apple Watch.

The Xiaomi Mi Band 3 really does it all, and is a



You cannot go wrong with the Xiaomi Mi Band 3

stand out offering considering the price point. It has a heart rate monitor, step tracker, an OLED touch-screen, 20-day battery life and is water resistant up to 50 meters, all for less than ₹2K. You really cannot ask for more. The only important feature missing here is the GPS chip.

THE CHEAPER ALTERNATIVES

The question that you really need to ask here, is that if you really need a fitness tracker. If the answer is yes, then why do you need it?

If you need it for the heart rate monitor, better not skimp on it. The good options are the Apple Watch Series 5, or any of offerings from Garmin. If you absolutely need it for the GPS, it

is better to invest in a device that does just that, and does that very well. The Yepzon GPS Tracker is a good option.

If you need the fitness tracker to only keep track of steps, then the GOQii Stride is a great option, which you should be able to get for less than ₹700 during a sale. The device clips onto your shoe and has a battery life that is much more than the rated three months (ours lasted about six months). It syncs with your smartphone, and you can just forget about charging it.

If you have an Apple phone, then the Apple



The Yepzon GPS Tracker



The GOQii Stride, an affordable step tracker

Watch is really the best smartwatch that you can get. A cheaper alternative to the Series 5 is the Series 3. If you just need a watch, then forget about smartwatches, and gain an appreciation for mechanical timepieces. A Seiko 5 will easily last 20 years, which is much more bang for the buck than any smartwatch on the market, which are likely to become obsolete within five years, if the batteries do not die by then. An additional advantage is that as the Seiko 5 is an affordable automatic watch, there is no need to worry about charging it. If you want to go for a more classic choice, then it is possible to find a good HMT watch in the second-

hand market. The Janata or the Pilot are good options, though there are many others. The Titan Edge series offers some incredibly slim and elegant quartz-based pieces. If you are willing to spend a bit more, then MVMT has some incredibly sharp-looking automatics available for a little over ₹22K. They tend to be perpetually sold out though, so it might be an effort to get your hands on one. 



The MVMT Arc Automatic